

The Unscannable QR Stunt

The reward they can never catch is the ad that never stops.

What It Is

A guerrilla marketing stunt-as-a-service. You hire one person to roam a busy city wearing a sign that reads "Free coffee if you can scan the QR code on me" — but they never stop moving, so the code is almost impossible to scan. The frustration becomes a game, crowds chase and film, and every clip is free advertising for the brand on the sign. You can pull this for your own coffee shop or sell it as a viral-launch package to local businesses.

How It Makes Money

The stunt itself is nearly free; the value is the attention. **For your own shop:** thousands of impressions and a flood of new foot traffic for the cost of a few cups of coffee. **As a service:** you charge local cafes, bars, gyms, and new store openings a flat fee to design, staff, and film the stunt, then hand them the viral clips for their own channels. Buyers are businesses that need a launch moment but can't afford paid ads.

Startup Costs

- Sandwich-board or wearable sign with printed QR: \$25–\$70
- Branded T-shirt or costume for the "runner": \$15–\$40
- The actual QR-linked landing page (free with Beaconstac/QR Code Generator): \$0–\$15/mo
- One day of labor for the runner: \$80–\$150
- A second person to film vertical video: \$0 (you) or \$50–\$100
- Coffee/reward inventory to give away: \$30–\$60
- Total per activation: **\$150–\$400**

The Numbers

One activation costs roughly **\$150–\$400** all-in. As a service, charge clients **\$500–\$1,500 per stunt** depending on city size and how many edited clips you deliver. Run 4 activations a month at \$750 each = **\$3,000/month** with maybe \$1,200 in costs, leaving **~\$1,800 profit**. For your own shop, a single stunt that nets 50,000 video views and 200 new customers spending \$6 each = **\$1,200 in first visits** off a \$250 spend.

How To Start

1. Build a simple QR landing page: email capture + a "you caught me — claim your free coffee" coupon.
2. Print the sign and brand the runner's outfit clearly with the business name.
3. Pick the busiest pedestrian zone in town (downtown lunch hour, festival, campus).
4. Brief the runner: keep moving, stay playful, tease the crowd, never let anyone scan cleanly.
5. Station a second person filming vertical clips of people chasing and laughing.
6. Let ONE person "win" near the end for a satisfying payoff clip.
7. Edit 3–5 short reels that night and post across TikTok/Instagram/Facebook with the brand tagged.

Where To Get Customers

For the agency version: pitch new restaurant/cafe/bar openings, gyms, and event organizers who need buzz fast. Show them a sample reel and a view-count screenshot. Post your own stunt footage to attract inbound clients. For your own shop, the stunt IS the customer-acquisition channel — the foot traffic and online reach feed each other.

Pro Tips

- **The frustration is the feature.** If it's too easy to scan, there's no chase and no story. Make it just barely impossible.
- **Always let someone win at the end.** The payoff moment is the most shareable clip and proves the offer is real.
- **Film everything vertically and post within 24 hours** while the moment is hot — speed beats polish on social.